

WEEK 5

Print Edition

Week 5 Study Guide

Bladder & Kidney Channels

BL (67 pts) + KI (27 pts) = 94 Points

This Week Covers:

- Bladder Meridian of Foot-Taiyang (BL1–BL67) with MOA + CAM figures
- BL 5 Branches — full detailed running course (longest channel in the body)
- BL 14 Crossing Points — the most of any channel
- Kidney Meridian of Foot-Shaoyin (KI1–KI27) with MOA + CAM figures
- KI 3 Branches — full detailed running course, ending at the Pericardium link
- KI 6 Crossing Points — abdomen and chest
- Full Back-Shu Series (BL13–BL28) — organ transport points
- Dr. Zhang's Clinical Pearls — direct from lecture
- BL vs KI Quick Reference — side-by-side comparison

QUIZ 4 (next class) covers: BL & KI channels.

BL & KI are taught this week; PC & SJ will be TAUGHT next week (Week 6).

MOA: BL pp.251-256 | KI pp.331-335

CAM: Col. Fig. 8-9 | Slides: Dr. Vivian Zhang, Week 5

The Bladder Meridian of Foot-Taiyang

Yang | Water | 3 PM – 5 PM | 67 Points

Pertaining Bladder

Connecting Kidney

Back-Shu BL28

Front-Mu CV3 Zhongji

Yuan-Source BL64

Luo BL58

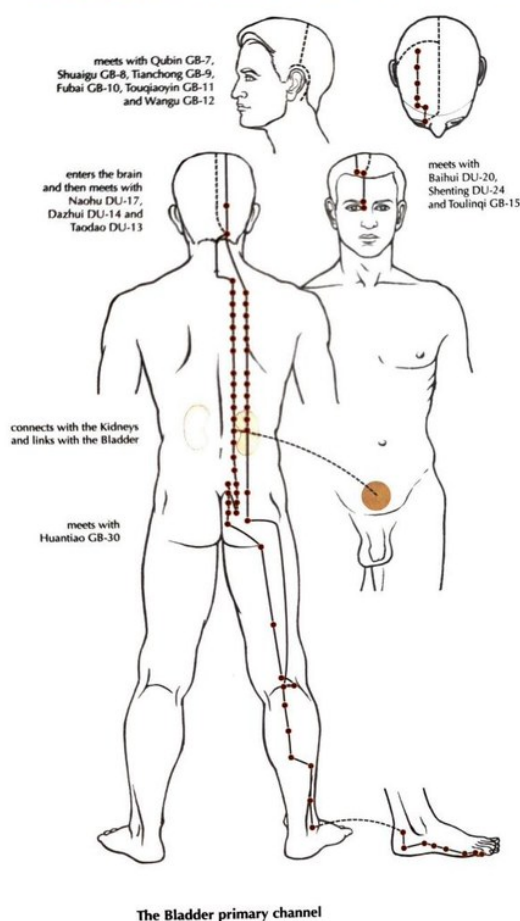
He-Sea BL40

Internal Running Course

Bladder Channel

251

THE BLADDER CHANNEL OF FOOT TAIYANG



The Bladder primary channel

MOA - BL Meridian (internal pathway)

- 1 Starts from the inner canthus (Jingming, BL1), ascends the forehead (BL2 Zanzhu, BL3 Meichong, BL4 Quchai) toward the vertex.
- 2 Continues up the forehead (BL5, BL6, BL7 Tongtian), joining the Governor Vessel at the vertex (Baihui, GV20).
- 3 BRANCH: from the vertex to the temple, crossing GB7, GB8, GB9, GB10, GB11 and GB12 — one of BL's 14 cross-points shared with the GV and GB channels.
- 4 STRAIGHT PORTION: from the vertex, enters and communicates with the brain, emerges and bifurcates at BL10 (Tianzhu) to descend the posterior neck.
- 5 Runs alongside the medial border of the scapula, parallel to the spine (BL11–BL17, alongside GV13/GV14), reaching the lumbar region (BL18–BL23).
- 6 Enters the body cavity, connects with the Kidney, and pertains to its home organ, the Bladder (BL24–BL30).
- 7 BRANCH: from the lumbar region, descends through the gluteal region and ends in the popliteal fossa (BL40 Weizhong).
- 8 BRANCH (largest): from the posterior neck, runs straight down the medial border of the scapula (BL41–BL54), through the gluteal region — meeting GB30 (Huantiao).
- 9 Descends the lateral thigh and meets the branch from Step 7 in the popliteal fossa (BL40), where the two lines merge into one.
- 10 Continues down the posterior leg (BL55, BL56, BL57) to the area behind the external malleolus (BL58, BL59, BL60).
- 11 Runs along the 5th metatarsal bone (BL61–BL64) to the lateral side of the tip of the little toe (BL65, BL66, BL67 Zhiyin).
- 12 LINKS with the Kidney Meridian of Foot-Shaoyin, continuing the Posterior Circuit.

Functions (MOA)

- Governs storage & excretion of urine (Water passageway)
- Longest channel; controls the posterior body surface
- Dominates tendons via the Bladder-Sinew channel
- ONLY channel carrying the full Back-Shu series (BL13–BL28)
- Front-Mu: CV3 Zhongji | Back-Shu: BL28 Pangguangshu

The Bladder Meridian (BL) - External Running Course & CAM Figures

Pertaining	Bladder	Connecting	Kidney	Back-Shu	BL28	Front-Mu	CV3 Zhongji	Yuan-Source	BL64	Luo	BL58	He-Sea	BL40
Pt	Chinese	Location & Notes											
BL1	Jingming	0.1 cun superior to inner canthus											
BL2	Zanzhu	Depression at medial end of eyebrow											
BL3	Meichong	0.5 cun within hairline, above BL2											
BL4	Quchai	0.5 cun within hairline, 1.5 cun lateral to midline											
BL5	Wuchu	1 cun within hairline, 1.5 cun lateral to midline											
BL6	Chengguang	2.5 cun within hairline, 1.5 cun lateral to midline											
BL7	Tongtian	4 cun within hairline, 1.5 cun lateral to midline											
BL8	Luoque	5.5 cun within hairline, 1.5 cun lateral to midline											
BL9	Yuzhen	2.5 cun within hairline, 1.3 cun lateral to midline											
BL10	Tianzhu	1.3 cun lateral to midline, within hairline											
BL11	Dazhu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T1 spinous process - Influential pt - Bone											
BL12	Fengmen	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T2 spinous process											
BL13	Feishu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T3 spinous process - Back-Shu - Lung											
BL14	Jueyinshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T4 spinous process - Back-Shu - Pericardium											
BL15	Xinshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T5 spinous process - Back-Shu - Heart											
BL16	Dushu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T6 spinous process											
BL17	Geshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T7 spinous process - Influential pt - Blood											
BL18	Ganshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T9 spinous process - Back-Shu - Liver											
BL19	Danshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T10 spinous process - Back-Shu - Gallbladder											
BL20	Pishu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T11 spinous process - Back-Shu - Spleen											
BL21	Weishu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border T12 spinous process - Back-Shu - Stomach											
BL22	Sanjiaoshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border L1 spinous process - Back-Shu - San Jiao											
BL23	Shenshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border L2 spinous process - Back-Shu - Kidney											
BL24	Qihashu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border L3 spinous process											
BL25	Dachangshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border L4 spinous process - Back-Shu - Large Int.											
BL26	Guanyuanshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border L5 spinous process											
BL27	Xiaochangshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border S1 foramen - Back-Shu - Small Int.											
BL28	Pangguangshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border S2 foramen - Back-Shu - Bladder											
BL29	Zhonglvshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border S3 foramen											
BL30	Baihuanshu	1.5 cun lat. to lower border S4 foramen											
BL31	Shangliao	1st posterior sacral foramen - Ba Liao group											
BL32	Ciliao	2nd posterior sacral foramen - Ba Liao group											
BL33	Zhongliao	3rd posterior sacral foramen - Ba Liao group											
BL34	Xialiao	4th posterior sacral foramen - Ba Liao group											
BL35	Huiyang	0.5 cun lateral to tip of coccyx											
BL36	Chengfu	Midpoint of transverse gluteal fold											
BL37	Yinmen	6 cun below BL36, on line to BL40											
BL38	Fuxi	1 cun above BL39, medial to biceps femoris tendon											
BL39	Weiyang	Lateral end of popliteal crease - Lower He-Sea of San Jiao											
BL40	Weizhong	Midpoint of popliteal crease - He-Sea; Command - back											
BL41	Fufen	3 cun lat. to lower border T2 spinous process											
BL42	Pohu	3 cun lat. to lower border T3 spinous process											
BL43	Gaohuang	3 cun lat. to lower border T4 spinous process - All deficiency-taxation											
BL44	Shentang	3 cun lat. to lower border T5 spinous process											
BL45	Yixi	3 cun lat. to lower border T6 spinous process											
BL46	Geguan	3 cun lat. to lower border T7 spinous process											
BL47	Hunmen	3 cun lat. to lower border T9 spinous process											
BL48	Yanggang	3 cun lat. to lower border T10 spinous process											
BL49	Yishe	3 cun lat. to lower border T11 spinous process											
BL50	Weicang	3 cun lat. to lower border T12 spinous process											
BL51	Huangmen	3 cun lat. to lower border L1 spinous process											
BL52	Zhishi	3 cun lat. to lower border L2 spinous process											
BL53	Baohuang	3 cun lat. to lower border S2 foramen											
BL54	Zhibian	3 cun lat. to lower border S3 foramen											
BL55	Heyang	2 cun below BL40, on line to BL57											
BL56	Chengjin	5 cun below BL40, top of gastrocnemius											
BL57	Chengshan	8 cun below BL40, apex of gastrocnemius - Classic for hemorrhoids											
BL58	Feiyang	7 cun above BL60, postero-inferior to gastrocnemius - Luo-connecting											
BL59	Fuyang	3 cun directly above BL60 - Xi-Cleft of Yang Qiao Mai											
BL60	Kunlun	Depression between lat. malleolus & Achilles tendon - Jing-River											
BL61	Pucan	Below BL60, 4 cun inferior to lateral malleolus											
BL62	Shenmai	Depression directly below lateral malleolus - Confluent - Yang Qiao Mai											
BL63	Jinmen	Anterior-inferior to BL62, lateral foot - Xi-Cleft											
BL64	Jinggu	Lateral foot, antero-inferior to 5th MT tuberosity - Yuan-Source											
BL65	Shugu	Posterior to 5th MT-phalangeal joint - Shu-Stream											
BL66	Zutonggu	Anterior to 5th MT-phalangeal joint - Ying-Spring											
BL67	Zhiyin	Lateral side of tip of small toe - Jing-Well; last point											

CAM Col. Fig. 8 - Bladder Meridian

CAM Col. Fig. 8 - Bladder Meridian

BL – Crossing Points (Detailed)

Dr. Zhang: "BL has 14 crossing points – the most of any single channel. Most are located around the head. Any headache/eye/neck symptom – always consider BL channel too."

GV24 Shenting + GB15 Toulinqi

GV24 / GB15

Location: Forehead / anterior hairline

Clinical: BL's first branch (BL2–BL4) crosses the Governor Vessel and Gallbladder channel here as it ascends the forehead toward the vertex. Used for frontal headache, dizziness, nasal congestion.

GB7–GB12 (six-point temple group)

GB channel

Location: Temple region, ear to mastoid

Clinical: BL's temple branch (Step 3) crosses all six of these Gallbladder points — Qubin, Shuaigu, Tianchong, Fubai, Touqiaoyin, Wangu. Migraine, temporal headache, tinnitus, TMJ-region pain.

GV20 Baihui

GV20 / Du Mai

Location: Vertex, midline

Clinical: BL joins the Governor Vessel at the very top of the head. Classic point for headache, dizziness, prolapse (organ/rectal/uterine), and calming the shen.

GV16 Fengfu + GV17 Naohu

GV16–17 / Du Mai

Location: Nape / occiput, brain region

Clinical: BL's straight portion communicates with the brain and crosses these two Du Mai points before bifurcating at BL10. Occipital headache, stiff neck, dizziness.

GV13 Taodao + GV14 Dazhui

GV13–14 / Du Mai

Location: Upper back, alongside BL11–BL17

Clinical: BL's back line runs parallel to the spine alongside these Governor Vessel points. Dazhui (GV14) is the meeting point of all Yang channels — fever, neck stiffness, immune support.

GB30 Huantiao

GB30 / GB channel

Location: Gluteal region

Clinical: BL's largest branch passes directly through this Gallbladder point in the buttock on its way down the posterior thigh. Classic point for sciatica and hip/low-back pain along the pathway.

BL – Syndromes & High-Yield Points

A. External Course Symptoms

- Headache (two head branches cross the brain region)
- Stiff neck, rigidity of the spine
- Low back pain, lumbar pain along the running course
- Sciatica-type pain, calf pain, stiff/painful leg
- Eye disorders (redness, pain, blurred vision – near BL1)
- Occipital pain, pain of the scapula and back

B. Internal Organ (Bladder)

- Difficult or painful urination, retention of urine
- Enuresis, dark or turbid urine
- Bladder-qi dysfunction generally
- Via Back-Shu series: dysfunction of ANY zang-fu organ
- (Dr. Zhang: acupuncture is especially effective for urinary retention)

BL13-BL28 = Back-Shu series | treats ANY zang-fu organ directly from the back
 Dr. Zhang: "Acupuncture is really good for the urination... just one point can treat it."

High-Yield Points

Pt	Chinese	Category	Key Indications
BL2	Zanzhu	Local eye point	Eye redness/pain, frontal headache, wind dizziness
BL10	Tianzhu	Neck region	Dizziness, occipital pain, neck rigidity, heavy head
BL13	Feishu	Back-Shu of Lung	Cough, asthma, chest fullness – treats Lung from the back
BL23	Shenshu	Back-Shu of Kidney	Low back pain, Kidney-deficiency patterns, tinnitus
BL25	Dachangshu	Back-Shu of Large Intestine	Diarrhea, constipation, low back pain
BL28	Pangguangshu	Back-Shu of Bladder	Difficult urination, retention, enuresis
BL40	Weizhong	He-Sea + Command (back)	Low back pain, stiffness of the spine; clears summer-heat
BL57	Chengshan	Calf belly	Classic point for hemorrhoids; calf cramp/spasm
BL60	Kunlun	Jing-River	"Aspirin of acupuncture" – headache, pain anywhere on pathway
BL62	Shenmai	Confluent – Yang Qiao Mai	Insomnia (daytime type), epilepsy, lower-limb disorders
BL67	Zhiyin	Jing-Well; last point	Corrects fetal malposition with moxa; labor induction

Five-Shu (Antique) Points - BL | Yang channel: Jing-Well = Metal

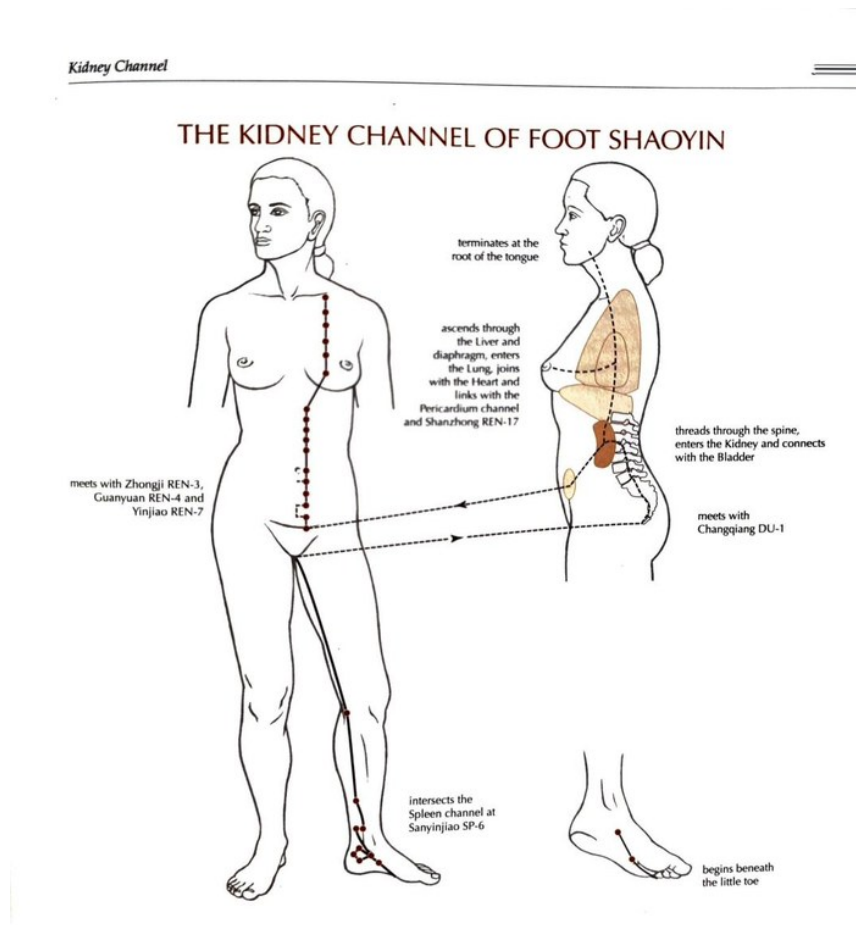
Shu Point	Element	Pt	Clinical Use
Jing-Well	Metal	BL67 Zhiyin	Loss of consciousness, epilepsy, mania; last-point resuscitation
Ying-Spring	Water	BL66 Zutonggu	Headache, neck pain, epistaxis
Shu-Stream	Wood	BL65 Shugu	Headache, neck rigidity, mania
Jing-River	Fire	BL60 Kunlun	Headache/pain anywhere; difficult labor; "aspirin" point
He-Sea	Earth	BL40 Weizhong	Low back pain, command point for the back; clears summer-heat

The Kidney Meridian of Foot-Shaoyin

Yin | Water | 5 PM – 7 PM | 27 Points

Pertaining **Kidney**Connecting **Bladder**Back-Shu **BL23**Front-Mu **GB25 Jingmen**Yuan-Source **KI3**Luo **KI4**He-Sea **KI10**

Internal Running Course



MOA - KI Meridian (internal pathway)

- 1 Starts beneath the small toe, runs obliquely to the sole of the foot (KI1 Yongquan).
- 2 Emerges below the tuberosity of the navicular bone (KI2 Rangu), curves behind the medial malleolus (KI3-KI8).
- 3 Enters the heel, ascends the medial calf to the medial side of the popliteal fossa (KI9, KI10 Yingu).
- 4 Continues up the postero-medial thigh toward the vertebral column, threading the spine, where it enters the Kidney (its pertaining organ) and connects with the Bladder.
- 5 STRAIGHT PORTION: re-emerges from the Kidney, ascends through the Liver and diaphragm, enters the Lung, runs along the throat, and terminates at the root of the tongue.
- 6 BRANCH: springs from the Lung, joins the Heart, and runs into the chest to link with the Pericardium Meridian of Hand-Jueyin – the channel that opens Week 6.
- 7 Internal course also passes through the lower abdomen and chest (KI11-KI27), crossing the Ren Mai at CV3, CV4, CV7 and CV17 along the way.

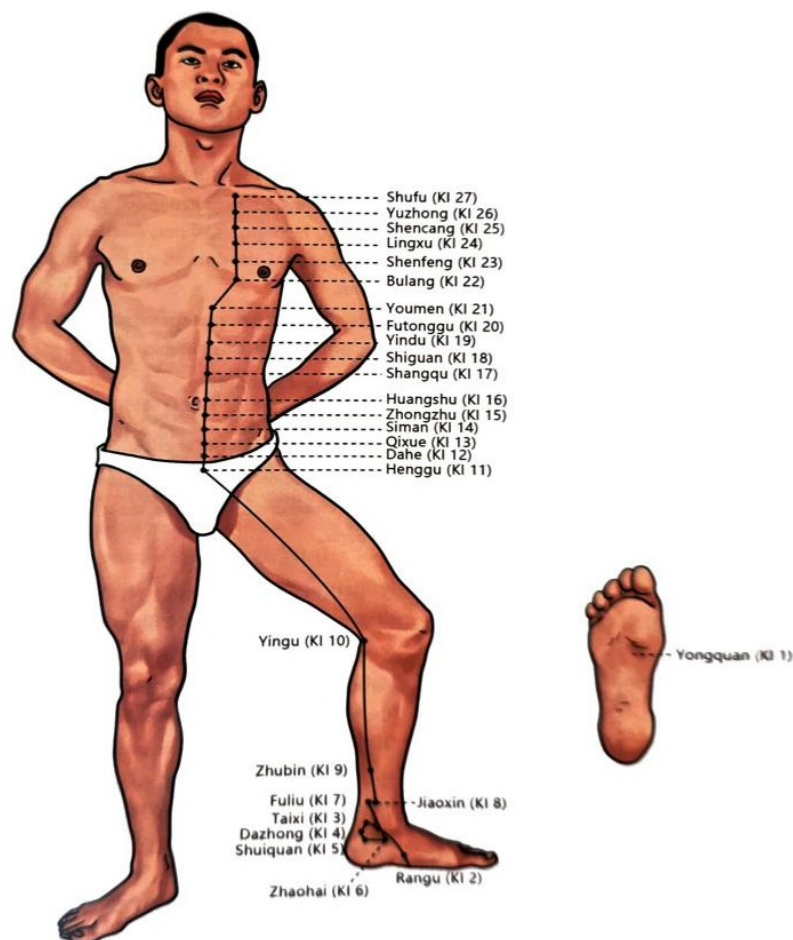
Functions (MOA)

- Stores Essence (Jing); root of pre-natal/constitutional Qi
- Grasps Qi – anchors respiration; asthma when this fails
- Governs bone, marrow, and hearing
- ONLY channel reaching the tongue root via a re-emerging branch
- Front-Mu: GB25 Jingmen | Back-Shu: BL23 Shenshu

The Kidney Meridian (KI) - External Running Course & CAM Figures

Pertaining Kidney	Connecting Bladder	Back-Shu BL23	Front-Mu GB25 Jingmen	Yuan-Source KI3	Luo KI4	He-Sea KI10
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Pt	Chinese	Location & Notes
KI1	<i>Yongquan</i>	Sole of foot, depression when plantar-flexed - Jing-Well; first point
KI2	Rangu	Below tuberosity of navicular bone - Ying-Spring
KI3	<i>Taixi</i>	Depression between medial malleolus tip & Achilles tendon - Shu-Stream; Yuan-Source
KI4	<i>Dazhong</i>	0.5 cun posterior to KI3, medial calcaneus - Luo-connecting
KI5	Shuiquan	1 cun below KI3, antero-superior to calcaneal tuberosity - Xi-Cleft
KI6	<i>Zhaohai</i>	1 cun below tip of medial malleolus - Confluent - Yinqiao Mai
KI7	<i>Fuliu</i>	2 cun above KI3, anterior to Achilles tendon - Jing-River
KI8	Jiaoxin	2 cun above KI3, posterior to KI7 - Xi-Cleft of Yinqiao Mai
KI9	Zhubin	5 cun above KI3, medial gastrocnemius head - Xi-Cleft of Yinwei Mai
KI10	<i>Yingu</i>	Medial end of popliteal crease - He-Sea
KI11	Henggu	5 cun below navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline
KI12	Dahe	4 cun below navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline
KI13	Qixue	3 cun below navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline
KI14	Siman	2 cun below navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline
KI15	Zhongzhu	1 cun below navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline
KI16	<i>Huangshu</i>	Level with navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline
KI17	Shangqu	2 cun above navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline
KI18	Shiguan	3 cun above navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline
KI19	Yindu	4 cun above navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline
KI20	Futonggu	5 cun above navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline
KI21	Youmen	6 cun above navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline
KI22	Bulang	5th ICS, 2 cun lateral to midline
KI23	Shenfeng	4th ICS, 2 cun lateral to midline
KI24	Lingxu	3rd ICS, 2 cun lateral to midline
KI25	Shencang	2nd ICS, 2 cun lateral to midline
KI26	Yuzhong	1st ICS, 2 cun lateral to midline
KI27	<i>Shufu</i>	Inferior border of clavicle, 2 cun lateral to midline - Last point



CAM Col. Fig. 9 - Kidney Meridian

KI - Crossing Points & Syndromes (Compact)

Dr. Zhang: "KI's 6 crossing points are mostly in the abdomen and chest (SP6, GV1, CV3, CV4, CV7, CV17) – this is why KI is so powerful for abdominal, reproductive, and chest conditions."

SP6 Sanyinjiao

SP6 / SP channel

Location: Medial leg, 3 cun above medial malleolus

Clinical: KI's ascending pathway intersects the Spleen channel here – the same 3-Yin meeting point shared with SP and LR. Gynecological disorders, insomnia; FORBIDDEN IN PREGNANCY.

GV1 Changqiang

GV1 / Du Mai

Location: Tip of coccyx

Clinical: KI's internal course meets the Governor Vessel at its origin point near the coccyx as it threads the spine toward the Kidney. Hemorrhoids, prolapse, lower back/sacral pain.

CV3 Zhongji

CV3 / Ren Mai

Location: Lower abdomen, 4 cun below navel

Clinical: KI crosses the Ren Mai at CV3 – also the Front-Mu of the Bladder. Urinary retention, menstrual disorders, genital pain.

CV4 Guanyuan

CV4 / Ren Mai

Location: Lower abdomen, 3 cun below navel

Clinical: A major Qi-tonification gate that KI's internal pathway passes through. Chronic deficiency, infertility, menstrual regulation.

CV7 Yinjiao

CV7 / Ren Mai

Location: Lower abdomen, 1 cun below navel

Clinical: KI crosses the Ren Mai again at CV7 on its ascent through the abdomen. Abdominal pain, menstrual irregularity, umbilical discomfort.

CV17 Shanzhong

CV17 / Ren Mai

Location: Chest, midline at nipple level

Clinical: KI's ascending branch reaches the chest near CV17 (the Sea of Qi / Front-Mu of Pericardium) before linking with the Pericardium channel. Chest oppression, cough, breast disorders.

A. External Course Symptoms

- Heel pain (Dr. Zhang's explicit clinical teaching point)
- Low back/knee weakness or pain along the medial leg
- Dry mouth, sore throat (pathway terminates at tongue root)
- Tongue-root numbness or stiffness (diagnostic sign)
- Cold sensation of soles, medial leg pain

B. Internal Organ (Kidney)

- Essence (Jing) deficiency – developmental, reproductive, aging concerns
- Kidney fails to grasp Qi – asthma, shortness of breath on exertion
- Poor bone/marrow, weak knees and lower back
- Tinnitus, deafness, hair loss/graying
- Night sweats, five-palm heat (Yin deficiency pattern)
- Edema, poor water metabolism

KI - High-Yield Points & Five-Shu

High-Yield Points

Pt	Chinese	Category	Key Indications
KI1	Yongquan	Jing-Well; first point	Resuscitation, calms spirit; used in hypertension
KI3	Taixi	Shu-Stream + Yuan-Source	Key tonic point for Kidney Yin AND Yang
KI4	Dazhong	Luo-connecting	Heel pain, weak lower back, apathy/low mood
KI6	Zhaohai	Confluent — Yinqiao Mai	Insomnia, sore throat, irregular menstruation
KI7	Fuliu	Jing-River	Tonifies Kidney Yang; edema; night sweats (pairs with HT6)
KI10	Yingu	He-Sea	Difficult urination, impotence, medial knee pain
KI16	Huangshu	Level with navel	Abdominal pain, constipation/diarrhea; near-navel landmark
KI27	Shufu	Last point	Cough, asthma, chest oppression — links functionally to PC channel

Five-Shu (Antique) Points - KI | Yin channel: Jing-Well = Wood

Shu Point	Element	Pt	Clinical Use
Jing-Well	Wood	KI1 Yongquan	Resuscitation, calms spirit, hypertension
Ying-Spring	Fire	KI2 Rangu	Sore throat, spontaneous sweating, diabetes-type thirst
Shu-Stream	Earth	KI3 Taixi	Yuan-source; master Kidney tonic, Yin AND Yang
Jing-River	Metal	KI7 Fuliu	Tonifies Kidney Yang; edema; night sweats
He-Sea	Water	KI10 Yingu	Difficult urination, impotence, medial knee pain

FORBIDDEN IN PREGNANCY (channels covered so far): SP6, LI4, BL60, BL67.

KI itself carries no individually forbidden point in the source material reviewed — flagged as not-yet-verified rather than assumed.

Dr. Zhang's Clinical Pearls - Direct from Lecture*Highest exam probability***BL is the Longest Meridian in the Body (67 pts)**

The running course has FIVE branches, two crossing the head and three running the back. Dr. Zhang narrated the pathway video and had students draw every branch. Know all 5: (1) inner canthus->vertex, (2) branch to temple, (3) straight portion vertex->bladder, (4) lumbar branch->popliteal fossa, (5) largest branch, posterior neck->little toe.

The Two Back Lines Run Simultaneously

Dr. Zhang, direct Q&A: a student asked whether the back line travels down, back up, and down again, or runs both lines at the same time. Answer: 'at the same time.' Do not draw it as one line doubling back — this is a common student error.

BL13-BL28: the Full Back-Shu Series

Every one of the twelve zang-fu organs has a dedicated Back-Shu (transport) point on the BL channel — BL13 Lung through BL28 Bladder. This is why BL functions as a 'bridge' channel: any organ system can be treated directly from the back.

BL60 Zusanli... no, Kunlun — the 'Aspirin of Acupuncture'

Dr. Zhang's nickname for BL60: broad-spectrum pain relief — headache, pain anywhere along the pathway, difficult labor. Command point logic parallel to ST36's role on the Stomach channel.

Heel Pain? Think Kidney First

Verbatim clinical teaching point from lecture: the KI pathway curves directly behind the medial malleolus and through the heel. This is called out explicitly as the first channel to consider for heel pain in clinic.

Only KI Connects to BOTH the Tongue Root and the Pericardium Channel

KI's straight portion re-emerges from the Kidney, ascends through Liver and diaphragm into the Lung, and terminates at the tongue root. A separate branch off the Lung links to the Pericardium channel — setting up Week 6.

BL & KI Pairing — Interior-Exterior Both Ways

BL descends (head to foot), KI ascends (foot to chest) — the same descending/ascending dynamic seen in ST/SP. Urinary and low-back conditions can be approached from either channel depending on whether the external pathway or the internal organ pattern dominates.

Posterior Circuit Complete: HT -> SI -> BL -> KI

After Week 5, the entire Posterior (Inner) Circuit is covered. Dr. Zhang's own closing framing: 'until now, we have learned the posterior circuit, and four meridians consist of the posterior circuit.' HT (chest->hand) -> SI (hand->head) -> BL (head->foot) -> KI (foot->chest).

BL Does NOT Connect to the Lung — Exam Trap

BL's only internal connection is to the Kidney. Do not confuse this with the Metal-element pathway or any Lung-adjacent function — this is a confirmed midterm-era trap note worth re-checking before Quiz 4.

Quiz 4 Fundamentals – Circuits & Nomenclature Review From Dr. Zhang's review slides

Distribution of the 12 Main Meridians

ON THE LIMBS:

Medial aspect: YIN meridians

Lateral aspect: YANG meridians

Posterior: Shaoyin (yin) / Taiyang (yang) <- BL/KI here

ON THE HEAD & TRUNK:

Posterior: Taiyang (BL)

BL = Taiyang = most posterior on trunk

Circulation of the 12 Meridians

c) Yang meridians of FOOT: head -> foot (BL)

d) Yin meridians of FOOT: foot -> chest (KI)

Qi flows one direction only – Dr. Zhang: 'it never goes back.'

This week completes the POSTERIOR circuit: HT -> SI -> BL -> KI

Circuit Connections – EXACTLY what links to what (exam trap)

- HT (Heart) -> connects to SI via the little-finger branch -> ulnar side of little finger (SI1)
- SI (Small Intestine) -> connects to BL, via the inner/outer eye canthus crossing points
- BL (Bladder) -> connects to KI at the foot branch -> lateral tip of the little toe (KI1 origin)
- KI (Kidney) -> connects to PC (Pericardium), NOT Lung -> via an internal branch through the chest

Dr. Zhang stressed: BL connects to KIDNEY (not Lung), KI connects to PERICARDIUM (not Lung either) – both trap answers point students toward Lung incorrectly.

Nomenclature

Meridian Name = 3 parts: (1) Hand or Foot, (2) Yin or Yang (Taiyin/Shaoyin/Jueyin, Yangming/Taiyang/Shaoyang), (3) Zang or Fu organ. e.g. "Bladder Meridian of Foot-Taiyang" / "Kidney Meridian of Foot-Shaoyin"

Meridian Clock – BL & KI peak times

BL (Bladder): 3-5 PM | KI (Kidney): 5-7 PM | Preceded by: SI 1-3 PM | Followed by: PC 7-9 PM

Full order: LU LI ST SP HT SI BL KI PC SJ GB LR – 24-hr cycle, 2 hrs each, Qi flows in sequence

*Dr. Zhang's homework rule: DRAW BOTH internal AND external pathways for every meridian.
"Some students only draw external – the internal pathway is also important."*

BL vs KI - Quick Reference Comparison

Attribute	BL Bladder (Foot Taiyang)	KI Kidney (Foot Shaoyin)
Yin / Yang	Yang (posterior)	Yin (posterior/medial)
Element	Water	Water
Circuit	Posterior — Head to Foot	Posterior — Foot to Chest
Clock	3–5 PM	5–7 PM
Points	67 (BL1–BL67)	27 (KI1–KI27)
Start	BL1 Jingming (inner canthus)	KI1 Yongquan (sole of foot)
End	BL67 Zhiyin (lateral little toe)	KI27 Shufu (below clavicle)
Branches	5 branches total	3 branches total
Pertaining	Bladder	Kidney
Connecting	Kidney	Bladder
Back-Shu	BL28 (of itself)	BL23
Front-Mu	CV3 Zhongji	GB25 Jingmen
Yuan-Source	BL64 Jinggu	KI3 Taixi
Luo	BL58 Feiyang	KI4 Dazhong
Xi-Cleft	BL63 Jinmen	KI5 Shuiquan
He-Sea	BL40 Weizhong	KI10 Yingu
Confluent Pt	BL62 (opens Yang Qiao Mai)	KI6 (opens Yin Qiao Mai)
Command Pt	BL40 (Back)	—
Crossing Pts	14 (mostly head/back — GV & GB)	6 (mostly abdomen/chest — SP, GV, CV)
Unique Feature	Longest channel; full Back-Shu series	Only channel to root of tongue via re-emerging branch
Ext Symptoms	Headache, neck/back/leg pain	Heel pain, dry mouth, sore throat
Int Symptoms	Urinary retention, dysuria	Essence deficiency, asthma, bone/marrow weakness
Qi Direction	Descends (head to foot)	Ascends (foot to chest)
Forbidden Preg.	BL60, BL67	—